



MINISTRY OF EDUCATION, SINGAPORE
in collaboration with
CAMBRIDGE ASSESSMENT INTERNATIONAL EDUCATION
General Certificate of Education Advanced Level
Higher 1



GENERAL PAPER

Paper 2

INSERT

8881/02

October/November 2025

1 hour 30 minutes

READ THESE INSTRUCTIONS FIRST

This Insert contains the passages for comprehension.

This document consists of 4 printed pages.



Singapore Examinations and Assessment Board



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Passage 1. An author questions the technology industry's use of AI and its impact.

- 1 As a concept, intelligence endlessly fascinates us. We have been arguing about it for centuries: what it is, how to measure it, who has it and so on. Ever since Alan Turing suggested that one day machines might become capable of thinking, interest in artificial intelligence (or in short – AI) has grown and is now at fever pitch with speculation about the prospect of so-called super-intelligent machines. AI emulates the cognitive abilities of the natural intelligence of human minds. To put it simply, it allows computers to learn and solve problems almost like a person. 5
- 2 AI technology is currently developing at high speed, perpetually growing more sophisticated and widespread. It is transforming many aspects of modern life, including changing not only the way we do things and how we relate to others, but also what we know about ourselves. There can really be no doubt that AI is a powerful tool that could affect everyone and everything in the world. 10
- 3 Many experts are taken aback by how quickly AI has developed, and they fear that its rapid growth could be harmful. For example, with the progressive development of AI, human labour may no longer be needed as everything can be done automatically. Will people become lazier if their bodies and brains are less engaged? There are even concerns about potential threats to human existence: 'these things could get more intelligent than us and could decide to take over, and we need to worry now about how we could prevent that from happening,' says a renowned computer scientist. 15
- 4 However, the fat cats in the tech industry are indifferent to these concerns. Their obsession with AI technology is simple, of course: it helps them profiteer by giving them the opportunity to build machines that learn from the behaviour of internet users to predict what they might do next and, particularly, what they are disposed to like and might want to buy. TikTok, which is just one example of a social media platform that relies on AI algorithms, bombards users with content related to previous media they have viewed on the platform. 20 25
- 5 As an unfortunate result, the tech industry is now addicted to a technology that has major technical and societal downsides. Machine-learning systems are too error-prone to be relied upon in applications where safety is critical, such as autonomous vehicles. They incorporate the racial, gender and ethnic biases implicit in the data on which they were trained. They are irredeemably opaque – even their creators are often unable to explain how their machines arrive at classifications or predictions and thereby fail to meet democratic requirements of accountability. To go back to the example of TikTok, criticism of the app targets this process and the algorithm's failure to filter out harmful and inaccurate content, raising concerns over TikTok's ability to protect its users from misleading information. 30
- 6 Despite the above concerns (and there are many more), it cannot be denied that AI is here to stay in our world. However, if we want to take advantage of its positive functions and abilities, any progress with AI technology must be treated with extreme caution. AI researchers, manufacturers and all industries must bear in mind that technology is to serve and not to manipulate humans and their society. 35



Passage 2. An author discusses the relationship between AI and education.

- 1 Education lies at the heart of what makes us human. The special status of education is why generative AI tools such as ChatGPT are likely to profoundly disrupt this sector. This is not a reflection of the intelligence of these tools, but of humans' failure to build education systems that nurture and value our unique human intelligence.
- 2 We are being duped into believing these AI tools are far more intelligent than they really are. A tool like ChatGPT merely collates bits of words together based on statistical probabilities, which can be used to produce helpful texts. In that regard, it is an incredibly useful assistant. However, it has no concept of how any of the words it produces relate to the real world. Therefore, many texts produced by ChatGPT will have limited value. The fact that AI can pass so many forms of assessment simply reflects that those assessments were not designed to test understanding but rather to test whether people had collected and memorised information. 5 10
- 3 Nevertheless, AI could be a force for tremendous good within education. Not only could it enable much more personalised and adaptive learning experiences, it could also release teachers from administrative tasks, giving them more opportunities to spend time with students. However, we are woefully equipped to benefit from the AI that is flooding the market, though I do not think it has to be like this. There is still time for us to prepare properly, but we must act speedily and smartly. One thing is for certain: there is no time to waste. 15
- 4 Staying ahead of AI will mean radically rethinking what education is for and what success means. Human intelligence is far more impressive than any AI system we see today. We possess a rich and diverse intelligence. We are capable of sophisticated, high-level thinking, yet too often school curricula take a rigid approach to learning, prioritising the memorising of facts rather than creative thinking. Students are rewarded for rote learning rather than critical thought. 20 25
- 5 Our education system should recognise the unique aspects of human intelligence. At school, this would mean a focus on teaching high-level thinking capabilities and designing a system to supercharge our intelligence, and current AI tools might not be developed enough to provide this.



Passage 3. A computer expert talks about the impact of AI on the traditional classroom.

- 1 Recent advances in AI are likely to spell the end of the traditional school classroom, one of the world's leading experts on AI has predicted.
- 2 Professor Stuart Russell, a British computer scientist based at the University of California, said that personalised ChatGPT-style tutors have the potential to hugely enrich education and widen global access by delivering personalised tuition to every household with an internet connection. The technology could feasibly deliver 'most material through to the end of high school,' he said. 5
- 3 'Education is the biggest benefit that we can look for in the next few years,' Russell said before a talk at the United Nations' *AI for Good Global Summit* in Geneva. 'It ought to be possible within a few years, maybe by the end of this decade, to be delivering a pretty high quality of education to nearly every child in the world. That's potentially transformative.' 10
- 4 However, he cautioned that deploying the powerful technology in the education sector also carries risks, including the potential for indoctrination. There are already plans to pilot virtual tutors powered by ChatGPT.
- 5 This prospect may prompt 'reasonable fears' among real-life teachers of 'fewer teachers being employed – possibly even none,' Russell said. Human involvement would still be essential, he predicted, but could be drastically different from the traditional role of a teacher, potentially increasing mentoring and pastoral responsibilities, facilitating more complex collective activities, and delivering greatly improved civic and moral education. 15
- 6 'We haven't done the experiments, so we don't know whether an AI system is going to be enough for a child. It will be essential to ensure that the social aspects of childhood are preserved and improved.' 20

Copyright Acknowledgements:

- Passage 2 © Rose Luckin; *Yes, AI could profoundly disrupt education. But maybe that's not a bad thing*; The Guardian News & Media Ltd; <https://www.theguardian.com/commentisfree/2023/jul/14/ai-artificial-intelligence-disrupt-education-creativity-critical-thinking> 14 July 2023.
- Passage 3 © Hannah Devlin; *AI likely to spell end of traditional school classroom, leading expert says*; The Guardian News & Media Ltd; <https://www.theguardian.com/technology/2023/jul/07/ai-likely-to-spell-end-of-traditional-school-classroom-leading-expert-says> 7 July 2023.

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GENERAL PAPER

8881/02

Paper 2

October/November 2025

1 hour 30 minutes

Candidates answer on the Question Paper.

Additional Materials: Insert

READ THESE INSTRUCTIONS FIRST

Write your Centre number, index number and name on all the work you hand in.

Write in dark blue or black pen.

Do not use staples, paper clips, glue or correction fluid.

DO **NOT** WRITE ON ANY BARCODES.

Answer **all** questions.

The Insert contains the passages for comprehension.

Note that up to **15** marks out of **50** will be awarded for your use of language.

The number of marks is given in brackets [] at the end of each question or part question.

This document consists of 7 printed pages, 1 blank page and 1 Insert.



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Answer **all** questions.

Your answers should be:

- written **in your own words as far as possible**. Where you select the appropriate material from the passage for your answer, you must still use your own words to express it.
- written in **continuous prose**.

From Passage 1

- 1 In paragraph 1, explain the author's use of the term 'fever pitch' (line 4).

.....

..... [1]

- 2 Using paragraph 3, identify **two** ways in which AI could have a negative impact on society.

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..... [2]

- 3 In paragraph 4, how does the author's use of language show disapproval of the tech industry's growing interest in AI?

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..... [3]





4 From paragraph 5, explain **three** ways in which the author illustrates the problems of AI technology.

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..... [3]

5 In what ways is the final paragraph an effective conclusion to the author's argument?

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..... [2]



6 Summarise the advantages and challenges that AI could bring to the education sector.

[8]

[8]



From all the passages

- 7 Passage 1 states that 'AI is a powerful tool that could affect everyone and everything in the world' (lines 11–12).

Identify **one** specific idea from Passage 3 which can be used to support this statement. Justify your answer.

.....

.....

.....

..... [2]

- 8 Passage 2 states that 'AI could be a force for tremendous good within education' (line 13).

Identify **one** specific idea from Passage 3 which can be used to undermine this statement. Justify your answer.

.....

.....

.....

..... [2]



How far do you agree that humans should be concerned about the use of AI?

- the ideas and opinions from **at least** one of the reading passages
- examples drawn from your own experience and that of your society.

[illegible]

DO NOT WRITE IN THIS MARGIN



Handwriting practice area with horizontal dotted lines.





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- Passage 2 © Rose Luckin; *Yes, AI could profoundly disrupt education. But maybe that's not a bad thing*; The Guardian News & Media Ltd;
<https://www.theguardian.com/commentisfree/2023/jul/14/ai-artificial-intelligence-disrupt-education-creativity-critical-thinking> 14 July 2023.
- Passage 3 © Hannah Devlin; *AI likely to spell end of traditional school classroom, leading expert says*; The Guardian News & Media Ltd;
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